COMPTIA SECURITY+ SY0-701 | DOMAIN 4 · SECURITY OPERATIONS (28%)

Security+ 4.1 · Securing Wireless & Mobile

Mestre CyberSec · **Lesson 4.1 — Securing Wireless & Mobile** (8:58) · Assistir Vídeo no YouTube ↗ · Treino Interativo: edusouzamarques.github.io/cybersec

Executive Lesson Summary: Wireless: site survey (mapa do RF); heat mapping (intensidade do sinal); WPA2/Ent (EAP-TLS+RADIUS cada user autentica) muito maior que PSK. MDM: provisionamento, app push, remote wipe. BYOD (pessoal) vs COPE (corporativo pessoal).

💡 Key Exam Highlights & Critical Concepts

- WPA2-Enterprise (802.1X+RADIUS) >> WPA2-PSK (senha compartilhada)
- MDM: gerência central do dispositivo; remote wipe se perdido

🎯 Exam Tips & Typical CompTIA Scenarios

- 'each user authenticates individually to wireless'=WPA2-Enterprise

🚨 Beyond the Video: Official Exam Concepts, Protocols & Traps (Section 4.1 — Securing Wireless & Mobile)

Why is this advanced coverage required for SY0-701?: Video lectures provide foundational concepts, but CompTIA tests practical engineering judgment and requires deep familiarity with the following protocols, acronyms, and operational nuances in this domain:

• WPA2-Enterprise (802.1X + RADIUS)
Enterprise wireless security mode that uses 802.1X with a RADIUS (or TACACS+) authentication server, providing per-user, per-session credentials via EAP methods like EAP-TLS.

⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Trigger: 'each user authenticates individually' or 'unique credentials per user' → answer is WPA2-Enterprise (NOT PSK). Always pairs with 802.1X and a RADIUS server.*

• WPA2-Personal (Pre-Shared Key) (WPA2-PSK)
Wireless security mode using a single shared passphrase (PSK) for all users, typically suited for home or small office environments without an authentication server.

⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Trigger: 'shared password', 'small office', or 'no authentication server' → answer is WPA2-PSK. If the same passphrase is given to everyone, it is NOT Enterprise.*

• EAP-TLS (Transport Layer Security)
An EAP method that uses X.509 digital certificates on both the supplicant (client) and the authentication server, providing mutual authentication for 802.1X networks.

⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Trigger: 'certificate-based wireless authentication' or 'mutual authentication with certificates' → EAP-TLS is the strongest EAP method. Know it requires PKI infrastructure.*

• Site Survey (N/A)
A physical assessment of a wireless environment using tools to map RF coverage, identify dead zones, locate access points, and detect interference sources before deployment.

⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Trigger: 'planning wireless deployment' or 'optimal AP placement' → perform a site survey. It is the FIRST step in wireless network design.*

• Heat Map (RF Heat Mapping) (N/A)
A visual color-coded representation of wireless signal strength and coverage across a physical area, used to validate AP placement and identify weak signal zones after a site survey.

⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Trigger: 'visualize signal strength' or 'verify wireless coverage' → heat map. Different from site survey: survey = plan, heat map = validate/visualize the result.*

• Mobile Device Management (MDM)

A centralized solution that enforces security policies, pushes apps and configurations, and provides remote control capabilities (lock, wipe, locate) on enrolled mobile devices.

⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Trigger: 'centrally manage corporate smartphones', 'push policies to devices', or 'remote wipe lost phone' → MDM. Required for corporate-owned and often for BYOD via containerization.*

• BYOD (Bring Your Own Device)

A mobile policy model where employees use their personal devices for work, requiring additional security controls such as MDM enrollment, containerization, or acceptable use policies.

⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Trigger: 'employee uses personal phone for work' → BYOD. Key concern: data ownership/privacy; usually mitigated with containerization or MDM with user consent.*

• COPE (Corporate-Owned, Personally Enabled)

A mobile policy model where the organization owns and fully controls the device, but permits limited personal use by the employee, balancing security and user flexibility.

⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Trigger: 'company owns the device but allows personal use' → COPE. Contrast: BYOD = user owns; COPE = company owns with personal use; Corporate-owned = company owns, work-only.*

✅ Authentic Practice Questions (10 Real Exam Scenarios)

Scenario-based exam questions. Complete explanations and distractor analysis are provided in the answer key below.

QUESTION 1 · EXAM SCENARIO

A logistics company is relocating to a newly renovated warehouse office. Before installing any wireless access points, the network team walks the entire facility collecting data about existing RF sources, signal coverage bleeding in from neighboring tenants, and physical obstacles such as metal shelving and concrete walls that could attenuate the signal. Which activity best describes what the team is performing?

A) Protocol analysis to decode beacon and probe frames at the location

B) Firmware baseline validation of the access points currently deployed there

C) Wireless site survey to map RF coverage and identify sources of interference

D) Vulnerability scan of the wireless controllers and access points on the site

QUESTION 2 · EXAM SCENARIO

Users on the third floor of a headquarters building complain that Wi-Fi performance drops near the elevators and in the corner conference rooms. The administrator wants to produce a color-coded visual representation showing the observed signal strength across every area of the floor so that coverage gaps can be located. Which approach should the administrator use?

A) A protocol analyzer to count retransmission frames near the elevators

B) An RF heat map generated from signal strength measurements taken across the floor

C) A port scanner to detect unauthorized devices connected to the wireless VLAN

D) An SNMP poll comparing CPU utilization across the floor's access points

QUESTION 3 · EXAM SCENARIO

A company secures its corporate SSID with WPA2 using a single passphrase shared by all 45 employees. After an employee is terminated, the security team realizes the former employee still knows the passphrase, and rotating it would require manually reconfiguring every laptop and phone. Management wants immediate per-user revocation of network access and centralized authentication. Which solution best meets these requirements?

A) Store a longer passphrase in a network share that employees can retrieve

B) Enable MAC address filtering on the APs and deny the former employee's laptop

C) Hide the SSID and require each employee to connect manually

D) Implement 802.1X authentication with a RADIUS server using per-user credentials

QUESTION 4 · EXAM SCENARIO

The security architect of a hospital is designing a new WPA2-Enterprise WLAN for medical staff devices. The compliance policy requires that the authentication process validate both the network to each connecting device and each device to the network, using digital certificates issued by the organization's PKI. Which authentication protocol should the architect select?

A) EAP-TLS

B) EAP-TTLS

C) PEAP with MSCHAPv2

D) WPA2-Personal with a 64-character random passphrase

QUESTION 5 · EXAM SCENARIO

A university is deploying 802.1X authentication across 300 access points managed by a central controller. The team needs a dedicated server that receives authentication requests forwarded by the access points, validates each user's identity against the institution's directory, and generates session records for auditing each wireless connection. Which type of server should be deployed?

A) An FTP server integrated with the directory

B) A DNS server with dynamic updates enabled

C) A RADIUS server

D) A syslog server for collecting AP event logs

QUESTION 6 · EXAM SCENARIO

A marketing agency has just purchased 250 company-owned smartphones to issue to field staff. IT must remotely enforce a six-digit screen lock, verify that device encryption is enabled, push a proprietary client application from the corporate app store, and restrict which application is used for corporate email — all at scale without physically touching the devices. Which solution should IT implement?

A) A cloud access security broker (CASB) to inspect traffic to cloud services

B) A mobile device management (MDM) platform to enroll and configure the devices

C) A next-generation firewall with SSL inspection at the network perimeter

D) A single sign-on (SSO) provider federated with the mail platform

QUESTION 7 · EXAM SCENARIO

A sales director leaves her company-issued phone in a taxi during an overseas trip and cannot recover it. The device contains cached corporate email, customer contact lists, and an installed VPN client profile. What action by IT most directly protects the confidential data stored on the lost phone?

A) Disable her directory account so she cannot log on from other devices

B) Blacklist the phone's IMEI with the mobile carrier

C) Rotate the VPN certificate authority while leaving the device profile in place

D) Send a remote wipe command to the phone through the MDM console

QUESTION 8 · EXAM SCENARIO

An executive team decides to strengthen mobile control while improving employee experience: the company will purchase the devices, retain full administrative ownership and apply corporate security baselines, yet employees will be allowed to install personal apps and use the devices for personal photos and messaging outside work hours. Which deployment model matches these goals?

A) BYOD, with staff using personally purchased devices for work

B) CYOD, with staff selecting from a catalogue of company-approved models for exclusive work use

C) COPE

D) Kiosk-mode deployment restricting each device to a single corporate app

QUESTION 9 · EXAM SCENARIO

A consulting firm allows employees to access corporate email and document repositories from their own personal phones. Company privacy agreements prohibit wiping entire personal devices or reading personal data, but corporate data accessed from those phones must still be protected. Which approach best satisfies both requirements?

A) Enforce a full-device remote wipe for any enrolled phone when its user resigns

B) Implement containerization so corporate apps and data run in an isolated, managed work profile

C) Require employees to disable biometric unlock and the personal camera application

D) Move corporate email to a public web portal that requires monthly password changes

QUESTION 10 · EXAM SCENARIO

During peak hours in a manufacturing facility, users report intermittent disconnects and low throughput even though their desks show full Wi-Fi signal strength. A technician discovers that every access point on the 2.4 GHz band was configured with the same channel for consistency. What should the technician do first to address the performance problem?

A) Perform a site survey and spectrum analysis, then reassign APs across non-overlapping channels 1, 6, and 11

B) Increase the transmit power on all access points to overpower competing signals

C) Deploy additional access points on the same channel to share the client load

D) Disable SSID broadcast on every AP to reduce beacon-frame congestion

ANSWER KEY & COMPREHENSIVE DISTRACTOR EXPLANATIONS

Question 1: Option C — Wireless site survey to map RF coverage and identify sources of interference

This is a wireless site survey: a pre-deployment walk-through that documents the existing RF environment, external signals from neighboring networks or devices, sources of interference, and physical attenuation factors (walls, metal racks, concrete). The results determine optimal AP placement, transmit power, and channel assignments. Protocol analysis decodes packets but does not map coverage, firmware validation checks device code rather than the RF environment, and vulnerability scanning assesses device security posture instead of where signal will propagate.

Question 2: Option B — An RF heat map generated from signal strength measurements taken across the floor

A heat map is a color-coded graphical representation of RF signal intensity overlaid on a floor plan, produced from measurements collected during a site survey. It visually exposes dead zones and weak-coverage areas such as the region near the elevators (metal shafts heavily attenuate RF) and corner rooms, directly supporting decisions on AP relocation or additional APs. A protocol analyzer could confirm symptoms like retransmissions but does not visually map coverage; a port scanner and SNMP CPU polling audit devices and AP workloads, neither depicting signal propagation.

Question 3: Option D — Implement 802.1X authentication with a RADIUS server using per-user credentials

WPA2-Enterprise replaces the shared pre-shared key with 802.1X port-based authentication against a centralized RADIUS server. Each user authenticates with unique credentials (traditionally tied to a directory such as Active Directory), so a single account can be disabled in seconds without touching any other device. A longer passphrase in a network share is a self-defeating workaround; MAC filtering is trivially spoofed and offers no centralized identity management; hiding the SSID does not protect the key and does nothing for revocation, since the passphrase remains a single shared secret.

Question 4: Option A — EAP-TLS

EAP-TLS is the certificate-based EAP method that provides mutual authentication: the server presents a certificate that clients validate, and each client must also present its own PKI-issued certificate, satisfying the policy's bidirectional certificate requirement (and it is widely considered the strongest EAP type). EAP-TTLS and PEAP-MSCHAPv2 establish a TLS tunnel to validate the server certificate, but clients authenticate with traditional credentials rather than client certificates, so mutual device authentication is absent. A 64-character WPA2-Personal passphrase remains a shared secret and cannot attest an individual device's identity.

Question 5: Option C — A RADIUS server

In an 802.1X deployment, the access point acts as the authenticator (supplicants are the user devices), forwarding authentication attempts to a RADIUS server, which is the standard AAA (authentication, authorization, accounting) backend for wireless enterprise networks. RADIUS validates user identities against a directory and produces accounting/session records for auditing. An FTP server transfers files, a DNS resolver name mappings, and a syslog server only passively collects event logs; none performs authentication or session accounting.

Question 6: Option B — A mobile device management (MDM) platform to enroll and configure the devices

These are core MDM capabilities: bulk enrollment of corporate-owned devices, remote enforcement of security settings such as passcode complexity and encryption, remote provisioning/push of applications, and application-level policy controls — all managed centrally from a console. A CASB governs traffic between users and cloud services but cannot configure device settings; a perimeter NGFW inspects network flows and does not manage endpoints; SSO simplifies application authentication but enforces no device hardening or app delivery.

Question 7: Option D — Send a remote wipe command to the phone through the MDM console

The immediate risk is the data physically residing on the lost device. MDM remote wipe erases the enrolled phone — removing cached email, contacts, and provisioned profiles/certificates — directly eliminating the data at risk. Disabling her directory account only affects her identity on other systems, not data on the phone; an IMEI carrier blacklist prevents the device from using the cellular network but leaves stored data untouched; rotating the CA may block future VPN connections but again leaves the cached data recoverable from the handset.

Question 8: Option C — COPE

COPE (Corporate-Owned, Personally Enabled) is defined by exactly this combination: the organization owns and fully controls the hardware and enforces its security baselines, while employees are permitted personal use such as personal apps, photos, and messaging. BYOD means the employee owns the device, giving the company far less administrative control. CYOD still leaves the company owning the devices, but its defining feature is the employee choosing the model, typically without personal-use enablement. A kiosk/dedicated deployment locks the device to one corporate function and contradicts the personal-use requirement.

Question 9: Option B — Implement containerization so corporate apps and data run in an isolated, managed work profile

Containerization divides a BYOD device into a managed corporate container (work profile) and a separate personal zone. Corporate email, documents, and apps run inside the container under company policy, and when a user leaves, only the container is wiped — personal photos, messages, and apps remain untouched — satisfying both protection and the privacy agreement. A full-device wipe explicitly violates the prohibition on wiping personal devices; disabling biometrics and the camera hardens the phone but neither isolates nor protects corporate data; a public web portal actually widens exposure and provides no policy enforcement over downloaded data.

Question 10: Option A — Perform a site survey and spectrum analysis, then reassign APs across non-overlapping channels 1, 6, and 11

Full bars with poor throughput is the signature of co-channel contention: all APs sharing one 2.4 GHz channel force devices and APs to take turns on the same airtime. A site survey with spectrum analysis confirms the RF conditions, and reassigning APs to the only three non-overlapping 2.4 GHz channels (1, 6, 11) restores parallel usable spectrum. Raising transmit power adds overlap and worsens co-channel interference; adding more APs on the same channel increases contention further; hidden SSIDs still emit beacon frames with a blanked name, so disabling broadcast reduces nothing and ignores the channel conflict entirely.